

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

The Story of You

A Journal for Meeting Yourself on Paper



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · self-discovery

WELCOME

Before You Begin



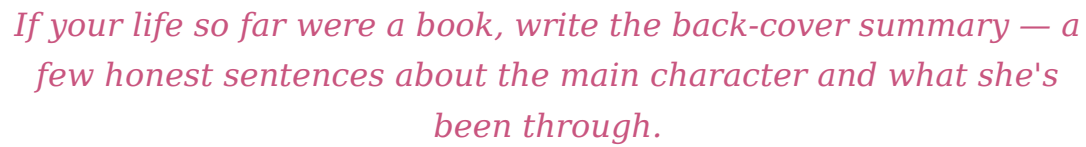
You've been the main character of your life this whole time —
but when's the last time you actually read your own story?

Not the version you tell at parties. The real one:
the chapters that shaped you, the plot twists you survived,
the character development nobody clapped for.

This journal walks you through your own book —
where you've been, who you are now, and where
the story goes next, with you holding the pen.

Write honestly. The author always knows the truth anyway.

The Back Cover



PART ONE

The Chapters Behind You



*You can't know where the story's going until
you honor where it's been.*

What are the five biggest chapters of your life so far? Give each one a title.



What's a moment that split your life into 'before' and 'after'?



Which chapter was the hardest to live through — and what did the character learn in it?



*What's a golden chapter you don't revisit enough?
Walk through it here.*



Who were the major characters along the way — the mentors, the villains, the ones who stayed?



What plot twist turned out, eventually, to be a gift in disguise?



PART TWO

The Character You've Become



*Character development is slow and mostly
invisible. Time to see yours.*

How would the people who love you describe you?

Now — how would YOU describe you?



What can you do now, or handle now, that a younger you couldn't have?



What are your character's core values — the things she won't trade, even under pressure?



*What contradictions live in you — soft and tough,
social and solitary? Name your pairs; they make you
real.*



What old version of yourself have you outgrown but still carry guilt or habits from?



What do you know for sure at this point in the story?
Make the list.



PART THREE

The Chapters You'll Write



*The best part of being the author: the ending
isn't written yet.*

If the next chapter had a title, what do you want it to be?



What does the main character want now — really want, underneath the practical stuff?



*What's one storyline you're ready to close for good?
Write its final paragraph.*



*What new character traits is she growing into?
What would the brave version of her do this year?*



*Years from now, what do you want the story to say
about how she lived?*



*Write the opening lines of your next chapter —
starting with today.*



Plot Moves for Stuck Chapters



When the story stalls, authors make a move. Check the ones you'll try.

- ☐ Change the setting — rearrange a room, take a new route, book the trip
- ☐ Introduce a new character — one class, group, or hello
- ☐ Give the main character a rest scene, guilt-free
- ☐ Cut a subplot that's draining the story
- ☐ Let her say the line she's been rehearsing
- ☐ Give her a small win on purpose this week
- ☐ Revisit an old dream and see if it still fits
- ☐ Write the scene you're avoiding — on paper first
- ☐ Ask: what would the reader be yelling at her to do?
- ☐ Turn the page. Start the next scene anyway.

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Lines Worth Keeping



Great books have underlined sentences. As you fill this journal, copy your own best lines here — the truths you wrote that surprised you.

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BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



You just did something rare: you read your own story
with honest eyes — the hard chapters and the golden ones.

Notice what the whole book shows: she keeps going.
Every chapter, no matter how dark, turned into the next one.

The pen is in your hand now. It always was —
you just needed to feel the weight of it again.

Go write a chapter worth underlining.



*Main character. Author. Same woman.
You.*



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